

Keeper's Watch

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Keeper's Watch

A VR exploration of an abandoned coastal lighthouse — no combat, no objective, just quiet spatial discovery and a story carried by sound.

SIT253 · Progressive Folio 1 · Experience & Exploration theme · Meta Quest 3S

Photo: Evgeni Tcherkasski / [Unsplash](#)

The Idea

Keeper's Watch places the user inside an abandoned lighthouse and its immediate grounds at dusk — the lamp room, the cliff path, and the rocky shoreline below. There's no combat and no objective. The whole experience is built around quiet spatial discovery, environmental storytelling (what happened to the keeper?), and an atmosphere carried almost entirely by sound: a distant foghorn, waves against rock, wind across the cliff top.

This is the planning stage — working out the theme, researching the genre, building a visual and sonic moodboard, and scoping out exactly what needs to get modelled, recorded, and edited before the lighthouse becomes something you can actually walk around in.

Folio at a Glance

THEME	Experience & Exploration
TARGET PLATFORM	Meta Quest 3S (standalone VR)
TARGET AUDIENCE	Atmospheric/narrative-driven VR explorers, plus maritime heritage groups
PLANNED 3D ASSETS	5 (4 required minimum + 1 stretch) — see Asset Plan
PLANNED AUDIO ASSETS	10 — see Asset Plan

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Folio Inquiry

Photo: Travis Leery / [Unsplash](#)

Theme

Experience & Exploration.

Concept

Keeper's Watch places the user inside an abandoned coastal lighthouse and its immediate grounds at dusk — the lamp room, the cliff path, and the rocky shoreline below. There is no combat or objective; the experience is built entirely around quiet spatial discovery, environmental storytelling (what happened to the keeper?), and atmosphere carried by sound.

Target XR Platform

Meta Quest 3S (standalone, room-scale VR) — the headset I actually own. It runs the same Snapdragon XR2 Gen 2 chipset and 8GB RAM as the Quest 3 (Road to VR, 2024), so the performance headroom I'm designing the models around (see Asset Plan) applies here too. The 3S mainly differs in display resolution (1832×1920 vs 2064×2208) and field of view (96° vs 110°) — that changes how sharp it looks, not what I can actually model.

I picked it because it's untethered and has good hand/controller tracking for close-up interaction with small props — rotating a lobster trap, picking up a lantern. The tight performance budget is also useful pressure: it keeps me optimising instead of just chasing detail.

Target Audience

Adults (16+) interested in atmospheric, narrative-driven exploration experiences — the "walking simulator" VR audience (players of *Firewatch*, *Dear Esther*, *What Remains of Edith Finch*) — plus a secondary audience of local heritage/maritime history groups who could use a piece like this for informal digital-preservation or tourism storytelling.

Ethical Considerations

- **Cultural/historical respect:** the keeper and their story are made up. I didn't want to put words in a real family's mouth just to make the concept sound more grounded.
- **Comfort/accessibility:** VR makes people sick easily, so I'm using teleport locomotion instead of free movement, and the cliff edges get a soft boundary for

anyone with vertigo.

- **Content suitability:** no jump-scares, despite the abandoned setting. This needs to stay a quiet, atmospheric piece, not tip into horror territory.

Why This Concept Fits the Audience

A quiet, abandoned space is a hard thing to sell on a flat screen — it needs presence to land. Standing at the actual scale of the lamp room, hearing the foghorn come from a specific direction outside, noticing how small the space feels compared to the tower's height from outside — that's the kind of thing VR does that video or photos of the same lighthouse can't. For walking-sim VR players, that's the entire appeal of the genre; for heritage groups, it's a way to let people feel a place's atmosphere even after the real site has been automated or fallen into disrepair.

For the heritage/maritime audience specifically, there's a social thread behind the emptiness that's the point of the piece, not just its backdrop: real lighthouses have been automated for decades — a light doesn't need a person standing next to it to switch on. But a keeper watching the water sees things a sensor doesn't: a boat that "looks wrong" before anything's technically an emergency, a change in the weather a machine wouldn't flag until it's too late. Automation removed the job, but not the reason someone was needed to do it. *Keeper's Watch* isn't just nostalgia for an old building — the empty lamp room and the keeper's absence are meant to make that loss actually felt, not just stated.

Keeper's Watch

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References

Photo: Igor Peftiev / [Unsplash](#)

Reference List

Blender Foundation, n.d. *Wireframe modifier*. [online] Blender Manual. Available at: docs.blender.org/manual/en/latest/modeling/modifiers/generate/wireframe.html [Accessed 16 Aug. 2026].

Technique reference for how I built the Lobster Trap's wire-mesh cage and funnel netting — the modifier itself, not a specific project tutorial. I used it to convert a flat grid mesh into an open lattice non-destructively rather than modelling each wire strand by hand.

Almeida, G.C. de, Andrade, A.O. and Vargas, P.A., 2023. Spatial audio in virtual reality: a systematic review. In: *Proceedings of the 22nd Brazilian Symposium on Games and Digital Entertainment*. New York: ACM. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3625008.3625042>

This is what convinced me the sonic moodboard isn't a side task. Spatial audio measurably affects presence, so ambient layering — the direction the foghorn comes from, how the waves sit relative to the wind — is core design work here, not polish added at the end.

Audacity Team, n.d. *Editing audio*. [online] Available at:

support.audacityteam.org/basics/audacity-editing [Accessed 26 Jul. 2026].

Going through the core workflow here — import, trim, layer — before I touch any raw recordings, so I'm not guessing my way through Audacity once Folio 2 production actually starts.

Eggers, R. (dir.), 2019. *The Lighthouse* [Film]. USA: A24.

Referenced for how it lights weathered material — heavy shadow, one hard light source doing all the work. I want the same in the scene: the lamp itself as the dominant light, not even ambient lighting everywhere.

Instructables, n.d. *Lobster Trap*. [online] Available at: [instructables.com/Lobster-Trap](https://www.instructables.com/Lobster-Trap) [Accessed 17 Aug. 2026].

Real-world reference for how a lobster trap is actually built and how its parts fit together — informed the frame/cage layout I modelled, not a step-by-step I followed to build the mesh.

Lamerichs, N., 2016. *The meaning of the island in art game Dear Esther*. [online] Available at: nicollelamerichs.com/2016/03/20/making-sense-of-indie-game-dear-esther [Accessed 26 Jul. 2026].

This is what pushed me toward environmental storytelling instead of a guided tour. The island in *Dear Esther* tells its story through what's been left behind, not dialogue — that's the approach I want for what happened to the keeper.

Leto 3D, 2023. *Lighthouse in Blender 4.0 | Beginner Tutorial* [YouTube video].

Available at: youtube.com/watch?v=kEJoL9FM0YE [Accessed 17 Aug. 2026].

Watched for general technique/reference only, not followed step-by-step — the Lighthouse Lamp Housing's actual construction (posts, rail rings, tapered shaft, lamp room) was built independently.

Lighthouses of Australia, n.d. *Point Lonsdale Lighthouse*. [online] Available at:

lighthouses.org.au/vic/point-lonsdale-lighthouse [Accessed 26 Jul. 2026].

Used for real proportions — how tall the tower actually is relative to the lamp room, how big the lamp housing is next to a person — so the Lighthouse Lamp Housing isn't just guessed at.

Meta, n.d. *Testing and performance analysis* — *Meta Horizon OS Developers*.

[online] Available at:

developers.meta.com/horizon/documentation/unity/unity-perf [Accessed 26 Jul. 2026].

Source of the 400–600 draw call / 1.3–1.8M triangle numbers on the Asset Plan page. I didn't want to guess at a "reasonable" polycount — I wanted the actual figure Meta recommends for this hardware.

Poeschl, S. and Doering, N., 2013. Integration of spatial sound in immersive virtual environments: an experimental study on effects of spatial sound on presence.

In: *2013 IEEE Virtual Reality (VR)*. IEEE, pp.129–130. DOI:

10.1109/VR.2013.6549396. Available at: researchgate.net [IEEE Xplore's own page for this DOI is currently down; ResearchGate mirror used instead].

A second, independent study backing the same conclusion as the Almeida review above. Two separate papers landing on the same point gave me more confidence it's not a one-off finding.

Price, A., n.d. *Blender Guru* [YouTube channel]. Available at:

youtube.com/@blenderguru [Accessed 26 Jul. 2026].

The tutorial series I'm actually going to work through on a practice object before touching a real prop — see the Reflection page for why.

Rapchak, C., n.d. *21 Lobster Trap Ideas*. [Pinterest board]. Available at:

ca.pinterest.com/cindyrapchak/lobster-trap-ideas [Accessed 17 Aug. 2026].

Visual reference for real lobster trap proportions and build variety — used for design/proportion sense-checking, not for mesh tracing.

Road to VR, 2024. *Quest 3S vs Quest 3 vs Quest 2 compared with detailed specs*.

Hayden, S. [online] Available at: roadtovr.com/quest-3s-quest-3-quest-2-specs-compared [Accessed 26 Jul. 2026].

Confirmed the Quest 3S shares its chipset and RAM with the Quest 3. That's the entire reason I can use Meta's Quest 3 performance figures for a 3S I actually own, instead of guessing at different numbers.

Ryan King Art, 2023. *Creating a Lighthouse in Blender - Part 1 (Tutorial)* [YouTube video]. Available at: youtube.com/watch?v=uK6qDmXkrEo [Accessed 17 Aug. 2026].

Same as the Leto 3D video above — watched for general technique/reference, not followed step-by-step, to avoid the academic integrity issue of copying a tutorial's build directly.

The Chinese Room, 2012. *Dear Esther* [Video game]. UK: The Chinese Room.

The main reference for the whole project, listed separately from Lamerichs' analysis above because I spent time playing it myself, not just reading about it — the pacing of discovery is what I'm trying to replicate.

Wikipedia contributors, n.d. *Lighthouse*. [online] Wikipedia. Available at: en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lighthouse [Accessed 17 Aug. 2026].

General background reading on lighthouse structure, terminology, and history (lamp room, gallery, lantern) so I was naming and proportioning the model's parts correctly rather than guessing.

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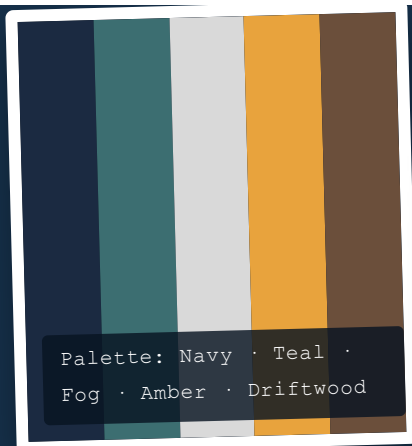
Asset Management & Timeline Reflection

Moodboard

Photo: Reza Madani / [Unsplash](#)

Visual Moodboard

Art style: Stylised low-poly with hand-painted-look textures (flat colour + baked shading, no PBR realism) — a deliberate choice that fits the Quest 3S triangle budget (see Asset Plan) and matches the painterly, slightly unreal tone of *Dear Esther's* island. Everything below — the palette, the typography, and the reference photography — is one board: five colours pulled from a foggy, lamp-lit coastline, paired with a display serif for the "voice of the keeper" and a clean sans for readability, then grounded against the actual materials (glazing, rust, driftwood) those choices are meant to evoke. The same five colours run through this website itself, so the site is built *in* the palette, not just describing it.



Watch

Fraunces for headings — a display serif with enough weight to feel carved, like lettering on a brass plaque.

SOURCE SANS · IBM

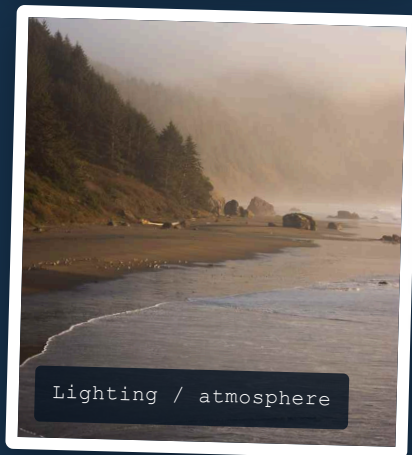


Photo credits: Lamp housing — Katja Ano / [Unsplash](#). Atmosphere — Alex Moliski / [Unsplash](#). Metal — Volodymyr Leush / [Unsplash](#). Timber — Sebastian Schuster / [Unsplash](#). Gathered for atmosphere, material, and proportion reference only — actual props are modelled from scratch, per the academic integrity requirements on the Folio Inquiry page.

Sonic Moodboard

One image/audio pair per sound category from the audio asset plan. **Folio 2**

update: the original fog/waves pair leaned too heavily on the same watery-ambient texture, so I've added a ship horn and a wind reference to actually spread the sonic palette across distinct sound types (nautical signal, water, wildlife, timber creak, wind, and — still open — a tonal drone) instead of stacking similar-sounding water loops.

AMBIENT

Fog over dark water

[Foghorn / lighthouse ambience ↗](#)

AMBIENT

Cliffside waves

"Waves and seagulls" by JosephSardin —
[Freesound ↗](#) (CC0, verified)

NAUTICAL SIGNAL

Distant ship passing offshore

"Ship Horn Very Close" by
freesound_community — [Pixabay ↗](#)
(Pixabay Content License, free for use)

ATMOSPHERE

Strong wind across the cliff top

"Bitter Cold Wind" by DRAGON-STUDIO —
[Pixabay ↗](#) (Pixabay Content License, free
for use)

FOLEY

Seagull on a ledge

"seagull.wav" by speakingmusic —
[Freesound ↗](#) (CC0, verified)

FOLEY

Old timber pier

"Door Creak" by stib — [Freesound ↗](#) (CC0,
verified)

TONAL / MUSICAL

Lamp room interior, warm light

Still open — haven't found a sparse
ambient drone that fits without also
pulling in unrelated nature sounds.
Searching Freesound's "drone" tag further
before locking this in.



Asset Plan

Photo: paws and prints / [Unsplash](#)

Planned Visual (3D) Assets

Quest 3S caps out around 1.3–1.8M triangles scene-wide (Meta, n.d.; same chipset budget as the Quest 3, per Road to VR, 2024) — that's why nothing below goes past a few thousand tris, even the hero asset.

ASSET NAME	CATEGORY	DESCRIPTION	TARGET POLY COUNT	TEXTURE SIZE
Lighthouse Lamp Housing	Hero prop	The rotating lamp mechanism at the top of the tower — the focal object of the scene.	~4,000 tris	2K (diffuse + emissive for the beam)

Weathered Rowboat	Environment prop	Beached, half-sunk wooden rowboat on the rocks below the cliff.	~1,800 tris	1K
Lobster Trap	Detail prop	Timber-and-rope trap left on the pier, hand interaction target. Update (Folio 2): ended up modelling the wire-mesh cage and the woven funnel netting as real geometry rather than baking them into the texture as originally planned here — the finished mesh is more detailed than this original scope, texture pass still to follow.	~900 tris (likely higher — see 3D Assets page)	512×512
Pier Post	Structural prop	Repeating weathered timber post used to dress the pier walkway. Same simplification — weathering/damage detail comes from texture, not modelled variation per post.	~400 tris	512×512
Seagull Nest (stretch, 5th asset)	Detail prop	Small nest on a cliff ledge, adds life/scale to the environment.	~600 tris	512×512

I've planned five props instead of the required four. The Seagull Nest is the one I can cut if time gets tight — more on that call on the Reflection page.

Planned Audio Assets

#	ASSET NAME	CATEGORY	DESCRIPTION	TARGET FORMAT
1	Foghorn_Ambient	Ambient	Distant recurring foghorn, looped	.wav, 44.1kHz/16-bit, stereo

2	Ocean_Waves_Loop	Ambient	Waves against rocks, looped bed layer	.wav, 44.1kHz/16-bit, stereo
3	Wind_Cliffside_Loop	Ambient	Wind gusts across the cliff top	.wav, 44.1kHz/16-bit, stereo
4	Seagull_Call_01/02	Foley	Two seagull call variations, non-looped one-shots	.wav, 44.1kHz/16-bit, mono
5	Pier_Wood_Creak	Foley	Timber creak, triggered near the pier posts	.wav, 44.1kHz/16-bit, mono
6	Lamp_Mechanism_Turn	Foley	Mechanical rotation sound for the lamp interaction	.wav, 44.1kHz/16-bit, mono
7	Footsteps_Gravel	Foley	Player footstep set on the cliff path	.wav, 44.1kHz/16-bit, mono
8	Rope_Creak_Rowboat	Foley	Rope/hull creak near the beached rowboat	.wav, 44.1kHz/16-bit, mono
9	Distant_Bell_Buoy	Ambient/tonal	Faint bell buoy far offshore, ties the scene together sonically	.wav, 44.1kHz/16-bit, stereo
10	Ambient_Drone_LampRoom	Tonal/musical	Sparse ambient drone inside the lamp room	.wav, 44.1kHz/16-bit, stereo

Mahmoud Osman · Student ID 225078724 · SIT253 Content Creation for Interactive Experiences ·
Progressive Folio 2

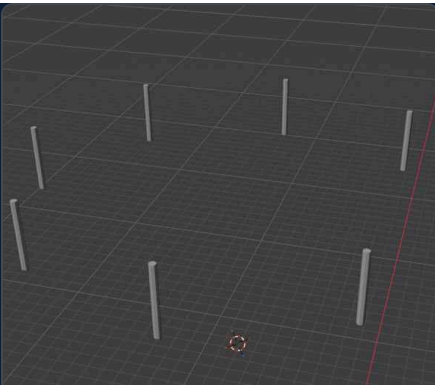
3D Assets — Progressive Folio 2

Photo: paws and prints / [Unsplash](#)

Two assets are underway for this checkpoint: the **Lighthouse Lamp Housing** (hero asset, fully modelled and textured) and the **Lobster Trap** (fully modelled, texture pass still to come). Both galleries below are ordered as a build breakdown — since I only started capturing process shots after most of the geometry was already in place, these are grouped by construction stage rather than a literal undo-history timeline. Each image is captioned with what that stage shows.

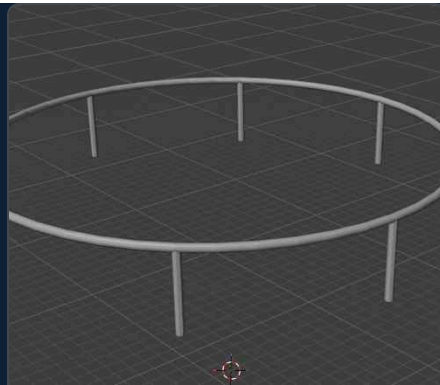
Lighthouse Lamp Housing

Status: Fully modelled and textured — the hero asset for this scene.



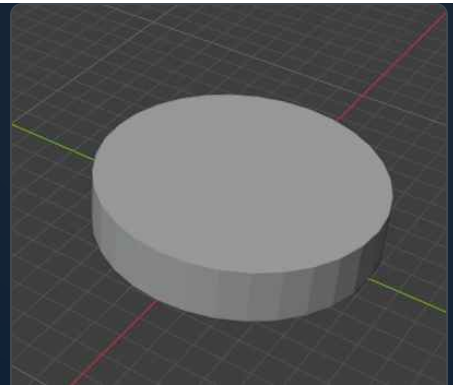
01 — Railing posts blackout

Individual cylinder posts placed in a circle before the rail rings were added.



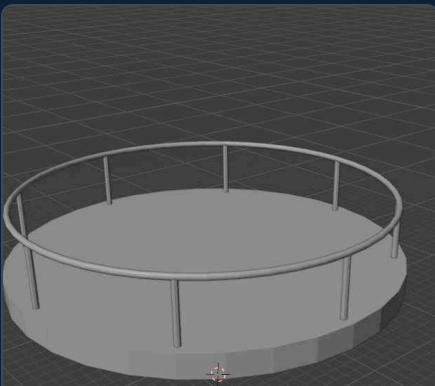
02 — Railing ring complete

Top and bottom rings joined onto the posts to form the gallery railing. This was the hardest part of the whole model — simple in concept, but getting the proportions to actually read correctly on the deck took a lot of trial and error.



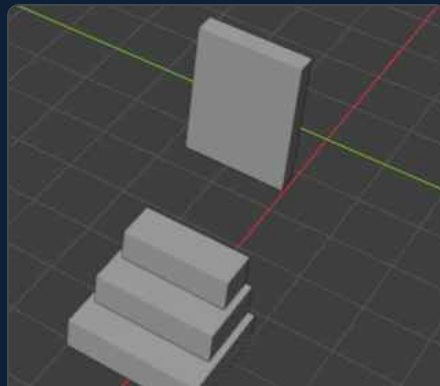
03 — Deck platform

The gallery deck — a simple flat cylinder.



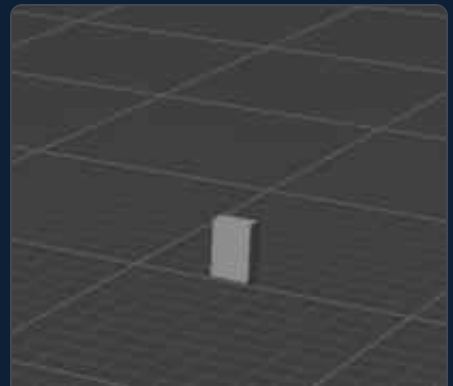
04 — Deck + railing combined

Railing merged onto the deck, forming the lamp gallery.



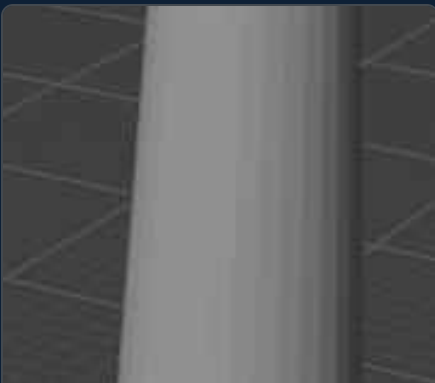
05 — Steps & door blackout

Entrance steps built from stacked boxes, plus the door panel — straightforward box modelling.

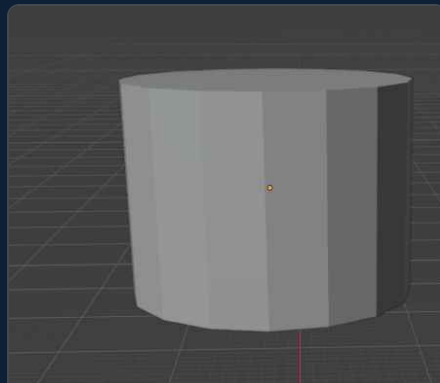


06 — Window panels

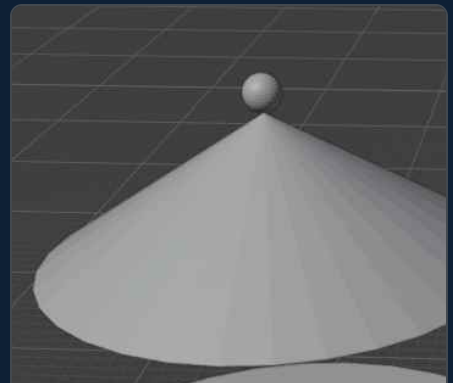
Simple box cutouts placed down the tower shaft.



07 — Tower shaft



08 — Lamp room

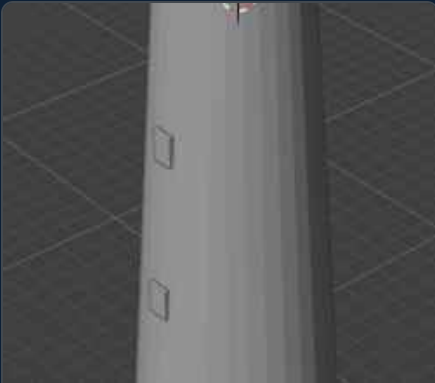


09 — Roof + finial

The main tapered-cylinder body of the tower.

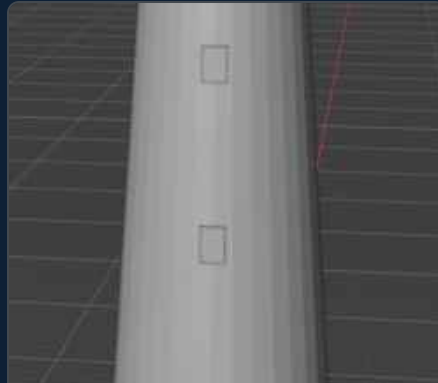
The wider cylinder that sits above the gallery, under the roof.

The cone roof and finial ball, completing the top of the tower.



10 — Full assembly (angle 1)

All pieces combined, subsurf smoothing applied.



11 — Full assembly (angle 2)

Second angle of the smoothed tower, showing the window spacing down the shaft.

Textured final renders



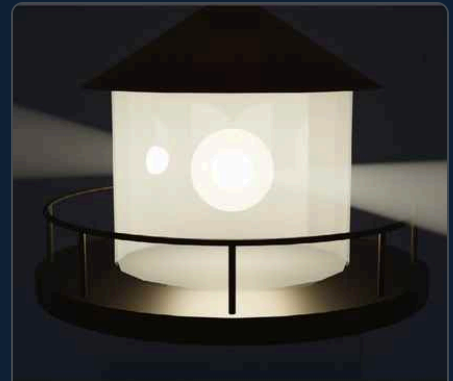
Daylight — full tower

White tower body, red roof, black railing, and wood-trimmed windows/door — the clearest view of the diffuse texture work.



Night — beam active

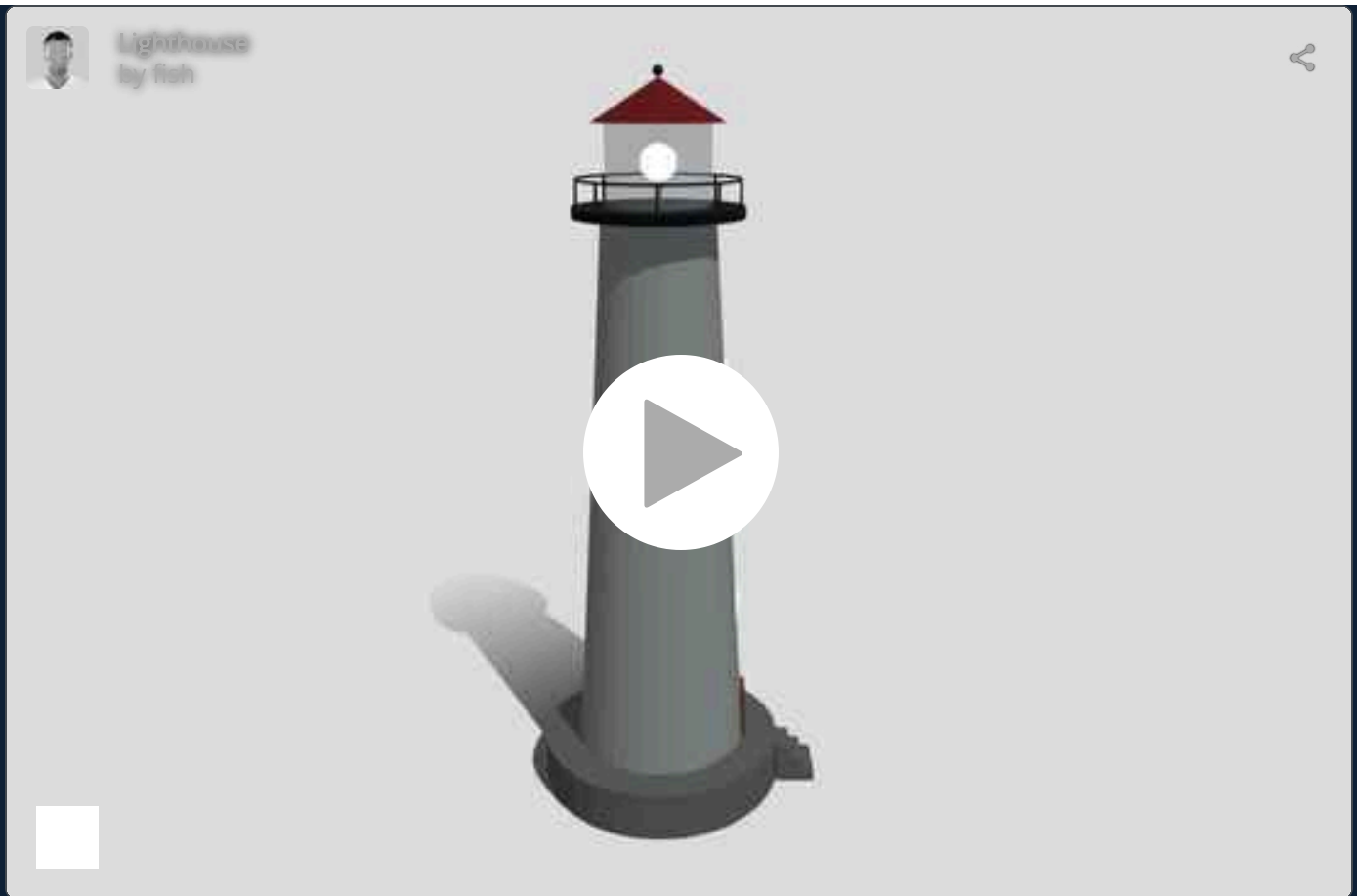
Emissive lamp material driving the light beam, shown against a dark sky.



Close-up — lamp room

Detail shot of the lamp bulb geometry, glass housing, and gallery railing.

SketchFab

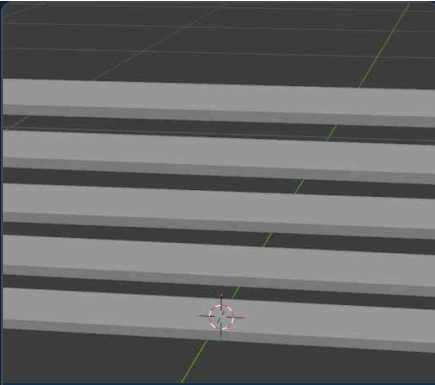


Interactive viewer — click and drag to rotate, scroll to zoom. Downloads disabled.

[View on SketchFab](#)

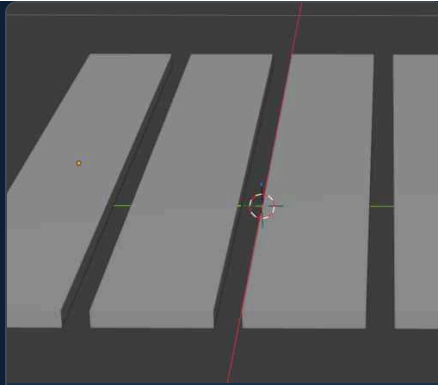
Lobster Trap

Status: Fully modelled, texture pass not started yet. This is a scope increase from the Folio 1 plan — I'd originally planned to bake the rope weave and wood weathering into the texture rather than modelling it, but ended up building the wire-mesh cage and woven funnel netting as real geometry instead.



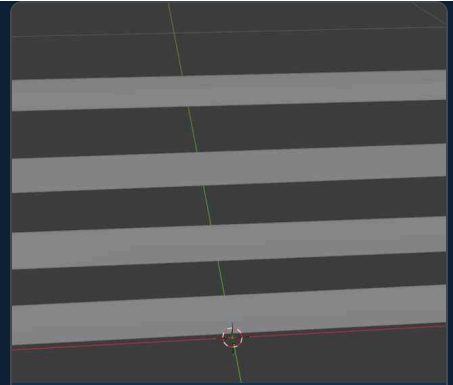
01 — Frame slats blackout

Loose flat slats that make up the trap's timber frame.



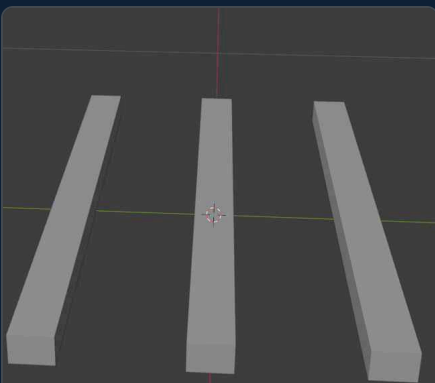
02 — Frame slats blackout

More slats being sized and spaced for the frame.



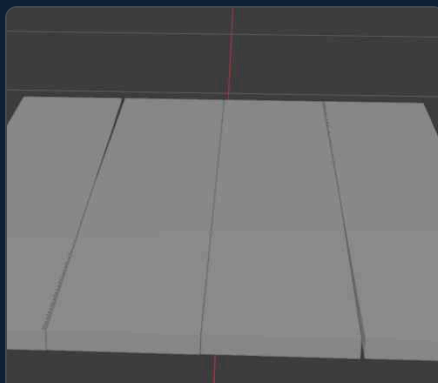
03 — Frame slats blackout

Same slat set from a wider angle.



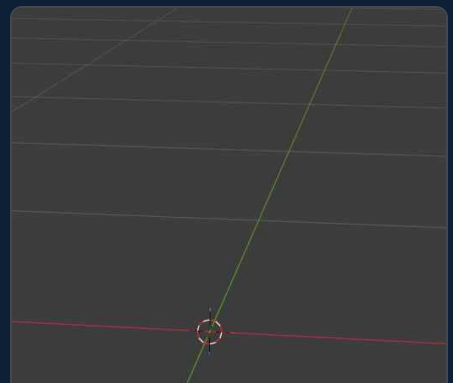
04 — Frame slats blackout

Angled slats for the frame's slanted sections.



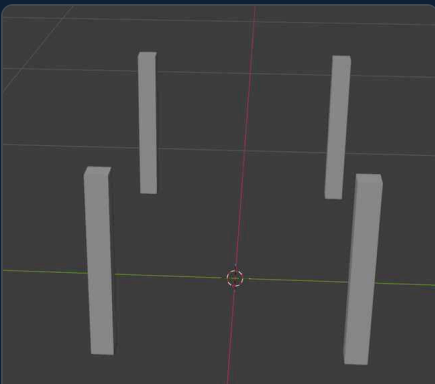
05 — Base/lid panel joined

Slats joined edge-to-edge into a single solid panel.



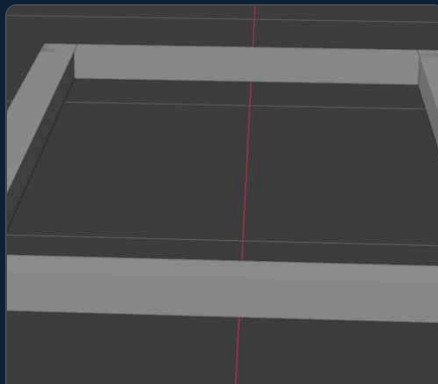
06 — Corner posts

The first pair of vertical corner posts.



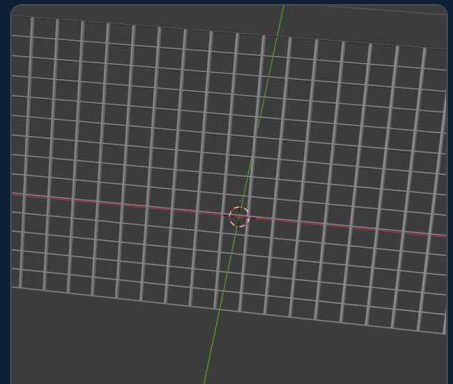
07 — Corner posts (all four)

All four corner posts placed to define the trap's footprint.



08 — Top rim frame

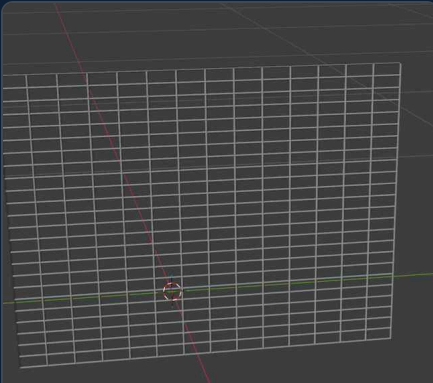
The square rim frame that ties the corner posts together at the top.



09 — Wire mesh panel

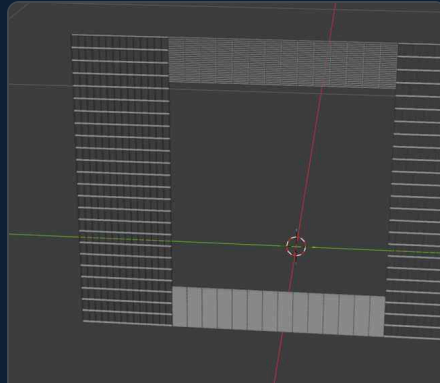
A single wall panel's wire mesh grid. This — and the funnel netting below — was the hardest part of the whole model: building a mesh grid is a completely different

workflow to just scaling a block up or down.



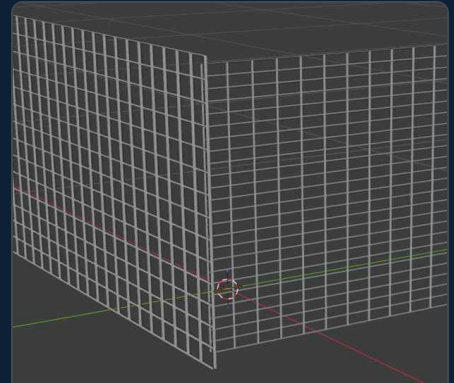
10 — Wire mesh panel

Closer view of the mesh grid pattern.



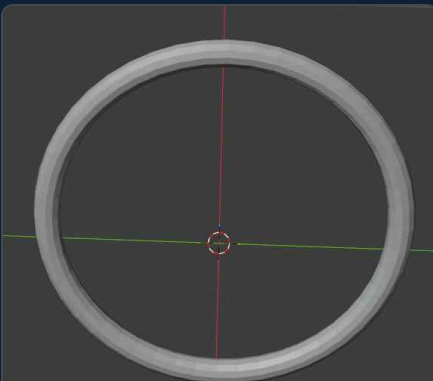
11 — Mesh panels, unassembled

All four wall mesh panels laid flat before assembly.



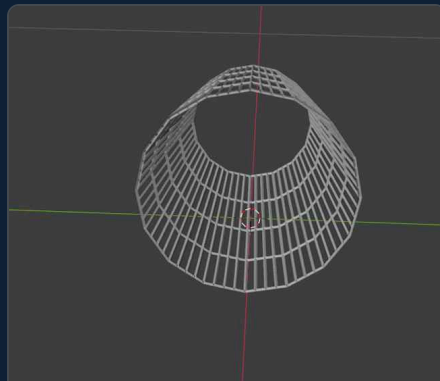
12 — Mesh walls joined

Two mesh walls joined at a corner in 3D space.



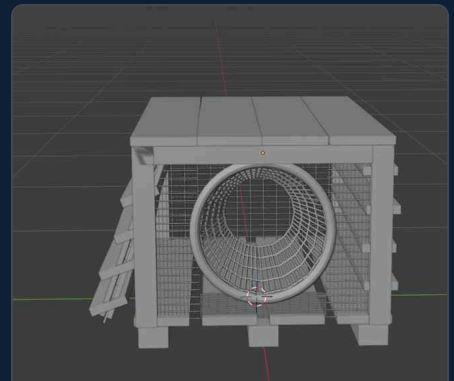
13 — Entrance ring

The ring that anchors the funnel entrance into the cage.



14 — Funnel netting cone

The woven entrance tunnel — the single most difficult piece to build on this asset.



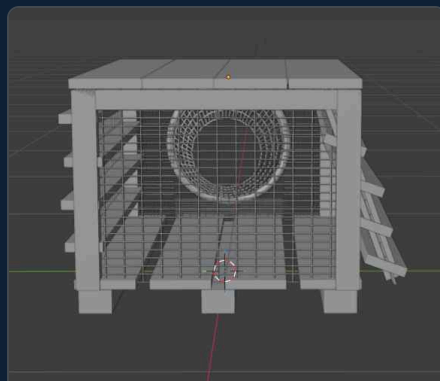
15 — Full assembly

All pieces combined — frame, mesh walls, rim, and funnel.



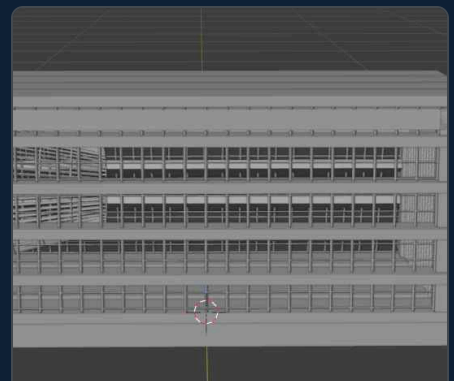
16 — Full assembly, front

Front view showing the mesh walls and lid slats together.



17 — Full assembly, angle 2

Three-quarter view with the funnel entrance visible.



18 — Full assembly, front close

Closer front view of the finished, untextured mesh.

Texture pass and 2D final renders — planned before the Final Folio.

SketchFab



Interactive viewer — click and drag to rotate, scroll to zoom. Downloads disabled.

[View on SketchFab](#)

Asset Management & Timeline

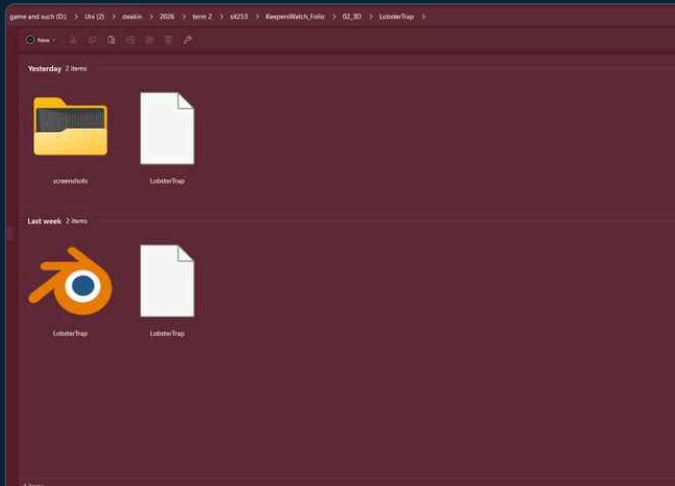
Photo: Fabian S / [Unsplash](#)

Asset Management System

My local folder structure traces straight back to the rows in the Asset Plan tables, so anyone opening it can find an asset without me walking them through it.

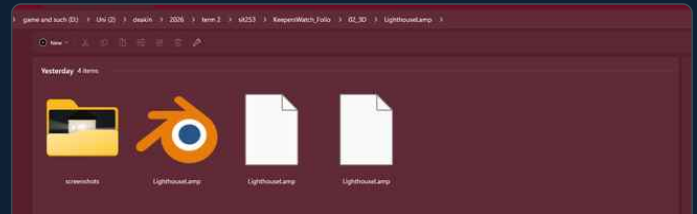
```
KeepersWatch_Folio/
├── 01_Reference/                (moodboard exports, research PDFs, citations)
├── 02_3D/
│   ├── LighthouseLamp/        - hero asset, DONE (modelled + textured)
│   │   ├── LighthouseLamp.blend (source file)
│   │   ├── LighthouseLamp.blend1 (autosave backup)
│   │   ├── LighthouseLamp.glb   (exported, SketchFab-ready)
│   │   └── screenshots/        (11 dev-process shots: blockout → assembly → textured final)
│   ├── LobsterTrap/           - DONE (modelled), texture pass pending
│   │   ├── LobsterTrap.blend
│   │   ├── LobsterTrap.blend1
│   │   ├── LobsterTrap.glb
│   │   └── screenshots/        (18 dev-process shots: frame → mesh cage → funnel → assembly)
│   ├── Rowboat/               - not started, planned Week 8-9
│   ├── PierPost/              - not started, planned Week 8-9
│   └── SeagullNest/            - not started, stretch asset, Week 10 if time allows
├── 03_Audio/
│   ├── Raw/                   (unedited source recordings/downloads – not started)
│   └── Final/                  (edited, folio-ready .wav files – not started)
```

```
|— 04_Documentation/          (asset list, timeline, working docs)
|— 05_Exports/                (final render screenshots, glTF/SketchFab bundles)
```



02_3D/ — all five asset folders

LighthouseLamp and LobsterTrap populated; Rowboat, PierPost, SeagullNest still empty (not started).



LighthouseLamp/ — populated

Source .blend, autosave, exported .glb, and the screenshots/ folder — real files, not a mockup structure.

Naming convention: AssetType_AssetName_Version — e.g.

3D_LighthouseLamp_v2.blend, AUD_Foghorn_Ambient_Final.wav. No generic names ("new folder," "stuff," "test"). Every folder/file name traces directly back to a row in the Asset Plan tables.

Why there's no separate textures/ subfolder: both completed models use Blender's Principled BSDF nodes with flat procedural colours (no external image textures — see the material breakdown for the Lighthouse Lamp's `LH\_White`, `LH\_Red`, `LH\_DarkMetal` etc.), so there's no UV-mapped image file to store separately; the colour data lives inside the `.blend` file itself. If a later asset (Rowboat, Pier Post) ends up needing an actual painted texture map, I'll add a `textures/` subfolder under that asset's own folder at that point, following the same naming convention.

Per-Asset Production Breakdown

Granular stage tracking per asset, since the phase-level table above doesn't show individual production steps.

ASSET	MODELLED	UV / MATERIALS	TEXTURED	REFINED & FINALISED
Lighthouse Lamp Housing (<i>hero</i>)	Done — Week 6	Procedural materials assigned (no UV needed,	Done — Week 7	Week 8 — fix window material contrast (currently reads flat under bright

		no image textures)		lighting), polish night-beam glow
Lobster Trap	Done — Week 7	Week 8 — decide procedural-colour vs. painted-image approach	Week 8	Week 9
Rowboat	Week 8	Week 8	Week 9	Week 9
Pier Post	Week 9	Week 9	Week 9	Week 9
Seagull Nest <i>(stretch, cut candidate)</i>	Week 10, if time allows	Week 10	Week 10	Week 10

Timeline

WEEK	PHASE	PLANNED TASKS & TARGETS	STATUS
Week 3	Conceptualisation	Lock theme + concept, build visual + sonic moodboard, draft asset list	Done
Week 4 (Fri 31 Jul)	Progressive Folio 1 due	Submit documentation, references, moodboards, asset plan, asset mgmt, timeline, reflection	Done
Week 5	Technical planning → Execution	Set up Blender project files per folder structure; begin Lighthouse Lamp Housing (hero asset)	Delayed — started later than planned
Week 6	Execution	Finish Lighthouse Lamp Housing (textured); begin Rowboat modelling	Delayed
Week 7 (now, Fri 28 Aug)	Progressive Folio 2 due	Minimum 2 completed/textured 3D assets, updated asset mgmt + timeline, reflection	Lighthouse Lamp Housing: modelled + textured. Lobster Trap: modelled, texture pending. Rowboat not started.
Week 8–9	Execution	Texture the Lobster Trap; begin Rowboat + Pier Post modelling; start sourcing raw audio	Planned (reordered — Rowboat pushed back to make room for the Lobster Trap's mesh work)
Week 10	Execution	Finish Seagull Nest (stretch asset, if time allows); edit all 10 audio assets; integrate	Planned

		scene in Sketchfab/engine	
Week 11 (Thu 24 Sep)	Final Folio due	All 4+ models, 10 audio assets, full eFolio polish, freeze + submit PDF	Due

Risk & Plan B

The Lighthouse Lamp Housing did take longer than the original Week 5–6 window — I was still learning box modelling basics, and the gallery railing in particular took a lot more trial and error to get proportioned correctly than I'd expected. It's now modelled and textured, just later than planned.

Folio 2 update: to keep to two assets for this checkpoint, I pulled the Lobster Trap forward from its original Week 8–9 slot instead of starting the Rowboat, since the Trap was scoped as the simpler prop and gave me a faster path to a second asset. In practice it ended up more involved than planned — I modelled the wire-mesh cage and funnel netting as real geometry rather than baking that detail into the texture — so it's fully modelled but not yet textured. The Rowboat is now pushed into the Week 8–9 window instead. The Seagull Nest (the stretch 5th asset) is still the first thing to cut if time runs short before the Final Folio.



Critical Self-Evaluation

Photo: Evgeni Tcherkasski / [Unsplash](#)

1. Shift in Perspective

Three weeks into this unit, the biggest change is that I now think about performance limits from the start instead of treating them as a problem for later. Before this, my instinct with any creative project was to build first and worry about constraints after. Planning *Keeper's Watch* against the Quest 3S's actual triangle and draw-call budget (Meta, n.d.) forced me to design each prop's level of detail before I've modelled anything, which is a different way of working for me.

2. Scoping & Prioritisation

I already simplified the Lobster Trap and Pier Post from my original plan. I'd initially pictured the trap with individually modelled woven rope and the pier posts each showing unique weathering and damage. Realistically, as someone who hasn't done much box modelling yet, that level of per-object detail wasn't a good use of time this early — it's a background/detail prop, not the hero asset. I simplified both to rely more on baked texture detail (rope weave, wood grain, weathering) rather than modelled geometry, which keeps them under budget and achievable without slowing down the Lighthouse Lamp Housing, which is where the real modelling effort should go.

3. Sourcing My Technical Guides

I don't have anything bookmarked yet, so I went looking for reputable channels instead of just grabbing the first search result:

- **Blender Guru** (Andrew Price) — youtube.com/@blenderguru — widely recommended beginner box-modelling series (his "donut" tutorial is the standard starting point most Blender learners are pointed to).
- **Audacity's own editing documentation** — support.audacityteam.org/basics/audacity-editing — for the core editing workflow (import, trim, layer) before touching looping or noise cleanup on the raw sound files.

4. Identifying Skill Gaps

3D modelling basics is what I'm least confident about — I haven't really used Blender before this unit. My plan is to work through the Blender Guru beginner series on a throwaway practice object (not one of my actual folio props) before Week 5, so I've made my early mistakes somewhere that doesn't cost me time on the Lighthouse Lamp Housing itself. If box modelling turns out to take longer than

expected, that's exactly why the Lobster Trap and Pier Post are already scoped down — that's my Plan B built in from the start.

5. Progressive Folio 2 Update

The Lighthouse Lamp Housing's gallery railing was the most challenging part to construct. Although it is a relatively simple design, consisting of a ring of cylinders, getting the proportions right was a matter of trial and error. Creating a set of posts and a rail that would be the correct size on the deck was not as simple to execute as the sketch suggested. The deck was considerably simpler, as it was a simple cylinder serving as a floor. The window, door, and steps were similarly simple to make, as boxes.

The most challenging part of the Lobster Trap to make was the wire mesh frame. It required an entirely different approach than simply scaling a block up or down. Furthermore, creating the weave that formed the funnel's entrance proved particularly challenging.